

- You're coding with IDE + terminal + docs → same group, same positions.
 - You're in WFH mode: Teams + notes + calendar → a "meeting group" you can rebuild quickly.
- Rule:** Build layouts for the workflows you repeat. Don't obsess over one perfect layout.

4) Windows 11 "Multitasking" settings

If snapping feels inconsistent on your laptop, it's often because snapping behaviors are configurable under System → Multitasking (exact wording varies by build). Microsoft's snapping guide explicitly covers keyboard snapping mechanics and is part of Windows' multitasking feature set.

Step-by-step: Check your snapping configuration

1. Open Settings (Win + I).
2. Go to System → Multitasking.
3. Look for Snap windows (and related toggles).
4. Make sure snapping is enabled.
5. Enable helpful options like showing layouts when you hover the maximize button (if present).

Why this matters: many OEM images ship with "helpful" utilities that sometimes interfere with default windowing behaviour. Keep Windows' snapping on and let Windows do it.

5) When Snap Layouts isn't enough

Snap Layouts gives you a handful of predefined layouts. FancyZones is what you use when your workflow needs something Windows doesn't offer by default: custom columns, asymmetrical zones, ultra-wide monitor layouts, or a "persistent" structure that matches your habits.

Microsoft's official documentation describes FancyZones as a PowerToys utility that lets you define specific zone locations on your desktop; windows snap into zones when dragged or triggered via shortcuts.

Microsoft also maintains a central PowerToys page listing FancyZones as part of PowerToys' utilities.

Step-by-step: Install PowerToys (the official ways)

Microsoft's install guide covers multiple methods including Microsoft Store and package managers.

Choose the easiest for you:

Option A: Microsoft Store (simplest)

- Open Microsoft Store → search "PowerToys" → install.

Option B: Installer from Microsoft

- Follow Microsoft's PowerToys install documentation route.

Option C: Package manager (for devs)

- Microsoft's guide includes package manager options such as WinGet.

Once installed, open PowerToys and you'll see a list of utilities. FancyZones is the one we care about in this chapter.

6) FancyZones basics: how snapping works

FancyZones works like this:

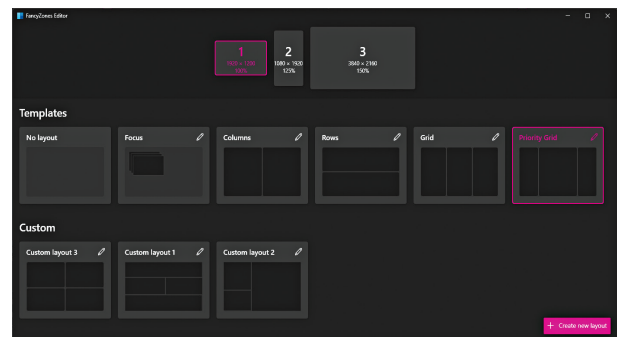
- You create a layout (zones).
- You drag a window while holding a modifier key (commonly Shift, depending on settings).
- The zones appear as overlays.
- Drop the window into a zone → it resizes perfectly.

Microsoft's FancyZones documentation explains the concept: define zones as targets; windows resize and reposition when placed into those zones.

Step-by-step: Turn on FancyZones and open the layout editor

1. Open PowerToys.
2. Go to FancyZones.
3. Enable it if it isn't already.
4. Launch the FancyZones editor (PowerToys provides a button for this in the FancyZones section).

Now you're ready to build layouts that fit your screen.



7) Create a "14-inch laptop" FancyZones layout

Most Indian laptops sit between 14–15.6 inches, often 1080p. That screen can support productivity, but only if windows stop overlapping.

Goal: a layout that matches real tasks

A very practical 14-inch layout is:

- Main zone (60%): writing/coding
- Side zone (40%): browser/reference
- Optional thin utility zone: chat/music/notes (only if your resolution can handle it)